

understands that, unless an individual employment contract provides otherwise, some team members may want to engage in outside employment (paid or unpaid), projects, and/or potentially-conflicting activities during their non-working hours (collectively referred to here as "outside activities").

GitLab reminds these team members that their position with GitLab is their primary employment responsibility, and that GitLab positions are considered full-time employment and they require a team member's full effort and concentration, despite any outside activities.

In order to honor the commitment team members make when they join GitLab, including protecting GitLab's confidential information, trade secrets, and other business interests while team members are engaged in outside activities, GitLab has adopted the following policies: Outside activities must not interfere with the team member's work performance or duties; or create an actual or apparent conflict of interest with GitLab. If outside activities lead to a team member's poor performance, abuse of leave policies, or other negative outcomes relating to their position, GitLab may discipline the team member, up to and including termination. In line with our core value of Transparency, prior to starting outside activities that could potentially interfere with their commitments to GitLab, team members must disclose it to their manager, as noted below. GitLab will not approve outside activities that compromise a team member's ability to perform their job effectively.

Team members engaging in outside activities must comply with GitLab's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, as well as all policies related to Conflicts of Interest, Confidentiality, Non-Competition during Employment, and the Protection of Confidential and Proprietary Information, where enforceable by applicable state or local law. Outside activities cannot involve or compete with products or services provided or under development by GitLab. Outside activities also cannot make use of any of GitLab's proprietary or confidential information, and team members cannot work in any capacity for any of GitLab's suppliers, customers, or competitors. GitLab's Internal Acceptable Use Policy permits limited personal use of GitLab-managed assets, subject to any conflicting statements contained in individual employment contracts. Subject to such limited personal use, team members may not use GitLab's facilities, equipment, supplies, IT systems (such as computers, networks, or email), time, trademarks, brand, or reputation in connection with any outside activities.

This policy is not intended to restrict communications or actions protected or required by state, federal or other applicable law.

Approval for Outside Activities

Before beginning outside employment, side projects, or other activities, whether paid or unpaid (collectively referred to as "outside activities"), you must disclose the activity in writing to your Manager, and further escalate as needed. Approval will not be granted if GitLab determines that the proposed outside activity would be a conflict of interest under the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics or if it would compromise a team member's ability to perform their job effectively. Candidates at a certain stage in the recruiting process will also be asked to disclose outside employment, side projects, or other activities in order for GitLab to determine whether a conflict exists with their ability to perform their obligations to GitLab.

Steps as a current candidate (actively engaged in the hiring process)

1. At the reference stage, the Recruiter will ask the candidate to complete a form that asks them the following:

to disclose any outside employment, projects, or activities; and any inventions or side projects that should be listed on the PIAA.

1. If the candidate discloses outside employment, projects, or activities in the completed form, CES will notify the hiring manager for approval and copy in Team Member Relations at teammemberrelations@gitlab.com for visibility and review to ensure consistency in application. Information that will need to be provided to the hiring manager shall include:

- Name of the outside employment, project, or activity
- GitLab clients who are involved in the project and scope of involvement (if applicable, please include tech stack used)
- Estimated time investment per week (in hours)
- Candidate's role in the outside employment, project, or activity

1. Approval will follow the process set out for current team members. Any potential conflict of interest must be disclosed to and approved by the Chief Legal Officer in line with the Code of Business Conduct & Ethics.

1. If the candidate entered No or None CES will continue processing the application.

Steps as a current team member

1. Team member check their individual employment contract to ensure they are not prevented from engaging in outside activities.

1. Team member sends their request via email to their direct manager for approval and adds the Team Member Relations team teammemberrelations@gitlab.com in copy for visibility and to ensure consistency in application.

Information needed in the email:

- Project name (links to relevant website if available)
- Goal of the project/organization
- GitLab clients and/or team members who are involved in the project and scope of their involvement. (If applicable, please include tech stack used)
- Estimated time investment per week (in hours)
- Employment status/role in relation to the outside project (if applicable)

1. The manager will ask any additional questions if necessary. A manager may not approve a request for outside projects or activities for a variety of reasons, including team member performance or a provision in an individual employment contract which provides otherwise.

1. If the manager and Team Member Relations approves, they will then confirm this in the thread and add the applicable Director-level leader to the thread, for their review and approval. If the direct manager is also at a Director-level, they will add the next level leader (VP or C-level as appropriate) to the email thread for review and approval.

1. If a decision by the manager and Team Member Relations is made to deny, the manager will relay this to the team member, and then will forward the email thread to the People Connect Team member at people-connect@gitlab.com to be saved in the team member's Workday Documents folder.

1. If the Director/next-level leader feels additional review and approval is needed, they will then add the next level leader (VP or C-level as appropriate) to the email thread. If this is not deemed necessary, the Director/next-level leader will respond indicating their approval.

Note: A minimum of two leaders must review all outside projects up to the E-group leader. If the E-group leader is the next level manager, the E-group leader approval or denial is sufficient. Direct manager and Director-level are the usual levels. If the direct manager is

at a Director-level, an additional level must approve or deny.

1. If the next level leader (VP or C-level) and Team Member Relations team feels additional review and guidance is needed, they will add the Senior Director of Legal, Employment and any other relevant leader to the thread. Any potential conflict of interest must be disclosed to and approved by the Chief Legal Officer in line with the Code of Business Conduct & Ethics

1. If a decision is made to approve and all approvals are documented, the People Connect Team member will save the entire thread as a pdf to the team member's Workday Documents folder.

1. The People Connect Team member will then respond confirming receipt and state that the entire thread has been saved in the team member's Workday profile.

1. For team members employed in the Netherlands, The People Connect Team member will state the given in the form of the Authorization Letter. This letter must first be sent to the relevant E-group leader for signature, then to the team member. Once signed, this will be saved in the team member's Workday Documents folder.

For any approved outside activity in which the GitLab team member will use their GitLab account, this activity must be stored in a separate, personal project. All other work completed as part of the work they perform on behalf of GitLab should be stored in a GitLab namespace.

Annual Code of Business Conduct & Ethics Administration Process

Employees are required to review and acknowledge GitLab's Code of Business Conduct & Ethics (aka "CoBCE") upon starting employment at GitLab, and annually thereafter, regardless if there are any changes to the code.

The People Connect Team tracks the Code of Business Conduct & Ethics signature completion by new hires during onboarding. The People Compliance team oversees and administers the annual signature process, which is tracked and distributed through Workday. The annual signature process usually launches in April if every year. Process steps include:

1. Legal reviews the most current version of the CoBCE. If any changes are suggested, they are incorporated and a most up-to-date version is created and updated to the Investor Relations section of our handbook.

1. The most current and updated CoBCE is uploaded to Workday and is formatted as to log team member's acknowledgment of the document, as well as the date it was acknowledged.

1. The People Compliance team crafts communications for the announcement of the process as well as any reminders and escalation. Legal and People leadership will review and approve these communications.

1. The People Compliance team announces to all team members (in Slack and email) that the annual CoBCE signature process is set to launch, and that the process will have a 30-day due date for 100% signature adherence.

1. The People Compliance Team creates the distribution list based on those who have not signed a CoBCE within the last three months prior to sending the new CoBCE.

1. The People Compliance Team launches the CoBCE to all relevant team members from Workday.

1. At two and three weeks post-launch, reminders from Workday are sent to individual team members who have not yet signed.

1. At four weeks post-launch, a final reminder email is sent to individual team members who have not yet signed, cc'ing their managers.

1. The People Compliance team will report weekly on progress and follow the escalation process after the 30 day window closes.

Code of Business Conduct & Ethics Escalation Process

1. At five weeks post-launch, People Compliance will send an escalation notification from Workday to individual team members who have not signed.

1. At six weeks post-launch, individual managers of direct reports who have not signed will receive escalation emails.

1. People Compliance will then follow the additional escalation process as described in the internal People Operations handbook. All communications templates are also found on this same page.

1. All escalation communication for any team member who has still not signed the CoBCE must be saved in the team member's Workday Documents folder.

1. Team members must be aware that failure to sign the Code of Business Conduct & Ethics may result in consequences up to and including offboarding, due to values misalignment.

Contract Renewals

The below process can be used for the following:

- Fixed term contract to indefinite contract
- Fixed term contract to fixed term contract (after the initial contract expires)
- Contract update for invoice purposes due to individual incorporation of an entity

Note: In most cases this process will apply specifically for team members in the Netherlands.

When creating a new contract, if it is to be for 12 months, that timeframe is always to be written as (for example):

- Jan 1, 2010 to Dec 31, 2010
- Feb 20, 2004 to Feb 19, 2005

When renewing a contract, if it is to be for 12 months, the timeframes are at be seen as (for example):

- First 12-month contract starts on June 14, 2019. That entails that the contract ends on June 13, 2020.
- Second 12-month contract will start on June 14, 2020 and end on June 13, 2021.

1. Add the team member's contract details to the People Connect Task Tracker under the Contracts tab. On the sheet you will assign the People Connect Team member owner, if you are the owner be sure to note the end date and start the below process 2 months before the end date.

1. Take note of the team members details and reach out to the team members manager via email using the following template.

1. Once you have received confirmation on next steps from the team members line manager, be sure to save the thread under the team member's profile in Workday in the 'Approvals - Confidential' document folder.

1. Using the correct contract template from the templates folder complete with required team member details. These details can be found on the team member's Workday profile.

- As we would honour the original hire date in terms of GitLab seniority add the following sentence into the contract after the contract start date: "Your continuity of service for statutory purposes begins on the {{Original Hire Date}}."
- Do not keep the Stock Options line in the Key Terms section, unless additional shares are being given.
- Be sure to write both the Start date and Birth date of the team member in the Month DD, YYYY format to prevent confusion.
- Remove any wording regarding Probation Period if applicable.

1. When you have a completed contract be sure to allow a team member to peer review it for you. This can be done by posting the document link in the connect-ops-team private slack channel. Indicate that you are reviewing it by using the 'Eyes' emoji.

1. Once reviewed, stage the contract for signing in Docusign.

1. Ensure that the GitLab signatory is the first to sign, followed by the team member. This can be done by selecting the assign signing order option.

1. When signed by both parties, save the contract to the team member's Workday Documents folder.

1. Update Workday to reflect the new contract information along with an end date if applicable.

1. Notify the People Connect team so that they may audit any Workday changes.

1. The People Connect Team member updates the People Connect Task Tracker confirming the contract has been completed.

Netherlands Renewal Process

1. Two months before the contract ends, HR Savvy will send an email to the People Connect Team member email address.

1. The People Connect Team member that is in charge of allocating contract renewals will assign a member of the People Connect team to complete the contract renewal process.

1. The People Connect Team member adds the team member's contract details to the People Connect Task Tracker under the Netherlands Contracts tab.

1. The People Connect Team member will follow this HelpLab Job Aid to request approval from the team member's manager two months before the team member's contract ends.

1. GitLab offers one fixed term 12-month contract to start. After the year-long fixed term contract, if the team member is in good standing, they are given an Indefinite Agreement beginning at the team member's second year with the company. If a team member has been with GitLab for over one year after their first fixed term contract finished due to a relocation, they are given an Indefinite Contract.

1. The Manager has then 2 weeks to evaluate the performance of the team member.

- If satisfied with the performance, the manager informs the People Connect team to extend the contract for an indefinite term.

- If there are performance concerns the manager will discuss the planned course of action with the Team Member Relations Team. The contract may end or get extended for another fixed term. The Team Member Relations Team can help with providing guidance on the messaging.

1. At least 1 month before the end of the contract, the manager informs the team member of the extension or not.

1. If a salary increase is required due to updated visa salary requirements the People Connect Team member requests approvals from the team member's manager, total rewards and finally the team member's Division's E-Group leader.

1. The People Connect Team member uploads the approval to the Workday Documents folder.
1. If the contract extension is approved, the People Connect Team member creates the contract

- As we would honour the original hire date in terms of GitLab seniority add the following sentence into the contract after the contract start date: "Your continuity of service for statutory purposes begins on the {{Original Hire Date}}."
- Do not keep the Stock Options line in the Key Terms section, unless additional shares are being given.
- Be sure to write both the Start date and Birth date of the team member in the Month DD, YYYY format to prevent confusion.
- Check whether the team member is currently paid the holiday allowance monthly. If yes, confirm with the team member whether we can update to yearly. If the team member agrees to update, ensure to update pay frequency. If no, confirm okay with Legal - Employment and ensure to add correct wording to this effect in new contract. To streamline the process all team members should receive the holiday allowance yearly.
- Remove any wording regarding Probation Period if applicable.
- Note: A second probation period should only be implemented if the team member's new contract reflects the start of an entirely new role. If the contract is simply a continuation of employment in the current role, a second probation period should not be applied.
- Remove any wording regarding certificate of good conduct, as this was already requested as part of their first Netherlands contract.

1. The People Connect team member stages the contract via DocuSign for the GitLab signatory and the team member to sign. Add hr@savvy-group.eu to 'Receive a copy' once signed.

- If another temporary contract is issued follow these steps and include the mentioned message when sending the contract via DocuSign

1. The People Connect Team member uploads the signed contract to the team members Workday Documents folder.
1. The People Connect Team member updates Workday to reflect the new contract: Open the team member's Workday profile > Click on actions > Job Change > add contract. Fill in start and end date, contract type and reason (if applicable)
1. Notify another People Connect Team member so that they may audit any Workday changes.
1. The People Connect Team member updates the People Connect Task Tracker confirming the contract has been completed.

Note: A team member cannot have more than three fixed term contracts with the same employer in a row. If a fourth contract is offered by GitLab then it must be a permanent one.

The Netherlands Contract Best Practices

1. Best practice for team members in the Netherlands is to issue one 1-year Fixed term Contract prior to moving to an indefinite contract. After the completion of the 1-year Fixed term Contracts, we move to the indefinite contract.
1. GitLab is to take into consideration the entire tenure of the team member at time of relocation to determine the type of contract to create. Due to the usual 1-year tenure at GitLab prior to a team member requesting to relocate and immigrate to the Netherlands, if the team member has been at GitLab more than one year, the best practice procedure would be to give

the team member an indefinite contract, with approval from their manager.

CXC Contract Renewal

CXC contracts are issued on a yearly basis, with contracts expiring after one year. CXC remains the responsible PEO for ensuring the contract renewal is completed for each team member.

- CXC will make contact with team members 2 weeks before their contracts are due to expire.
- CXC will create renewal contract and send for signing to the relevant team members.
- Once signed, CXC will send the renewed contract to People Connect.
- The People Connect Team member uploads the renewed contract to the team member's Workday Contracts & Changes folder and updates Workday to reflect the new contract.

Standard practice is to automatically renew CXC contracts. The offboarding process will apply should a team member be terminated voluntarily or involuntarily.

GitLab Inc Best Practices

GitLab, Inc with OTE

- For Relocations, Promotions, and Transfers of current team members be sure to remove the draw information as it is not applicable.

SECTION: people-group/directly-responsible-individuals.md

What is a directly responsible individual?

Apple coined the term "directly responsible individual" (DRI) to refer to the one person with whom the buck stopped on any given project.

The idea is that every project is assigned a DRI who is ultimately held accountable for the success (or failure) of that project.

They likely won't be the only person working on their assigned project, but it's "up to that person to get it done or find the resources needed."

The DRI might be a manager or team leader, they might even be an executive.

Or, they may themselves be individually responsible for fulfilling all the needs of their project.

The selection of a DRI and their specific role will vary based on their own skillset and the requirements of their assigned task.

What's most important is that they're empowered.

We may disagree, commit, and disagree, but we all have to achieve results on every decision while it stands, even when it's trying to have it changed.

While the DRI is the individual who is ultimately held accountable for the success or failure of any given project, they are not necessarily the individual that does the tactical project work. The DRI should consult and collaborate with all teams and stakeholders involved to ensure they have all relevant context, to gather input/feedback from others, and to divide action

items and tasks amongst those involved.

Empowering DRIs

It is important to understand that DRIs do not owe anyone an explanation for their decisions. If you force a DRI to explain too much, you'll create incentives to ship projects under the radar. The fear of falling into a perpetual loop of explaining can derail a DRI, and cause people to defer rather than working with a bias for action.

We would much rather foster a culture where DRIs are willing to put their ideas in the open. This enables feedback from a broad range of diverse perspectives, which the DRI can take into account and choose how (if at all) it shapes their thinking.

{{< youtube "jdN5mj5ieLk?start=1775" >}}

As part of a Harvard Business School case study interview (shown above), GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij spoke with Professor Prithwiraj Choudhury on various elements of GitLab's all-remote structure, including a question on DRIs.

> How do we get the best of consensus organizations? When we're about to make a decision, we tell everyone. Everyone can give input.

>

> How we keep the best of hierarchical organizations is by having a DRI - one person who will decide.

>

> Now, there's one tricky thing here. If you make the DRI convince or explain their decision too much to all the people who provided input, you'll get projects that fly under the radar. I've seen this in a lot of companies.

>

> Very explicitly, a DRI [at GitLab] does not have to explain why they're making a decision, and they absolutely do not have to convince other people.

>

> So, you get to provide input, but you don't have the right to feeling heard or being considered in the eventual decision.

DRIs and our Values

At the end of the day, it's about results and efficiency.

DRIs work conceptually because they leave no room for ambiguity about who has the final say on all questions that arise within a project or team.

Assigning one, ultimately responsible person to a project might seem to impair our ability to collaborate effectively at first glance, but that's misleading.

The DRI should be wholly invested in their assignment and welcome collaboration in order to succeed.

While they're empowered to make all final decisions, they should know how and when to trust in the experience and judgment of their teams and peers.

Of course, when things do go wrong, it's also the DRI who (usually) takes the fall as was the case when Scott Forestall, then iOS senior vice president, was forced to resign after he

"refused to sign the letter apologizing" for Apple's infamously error-laden Maps app redesign in 2011.

Characteristics of a Project DRI

DRIs are most often assigned at the task-level. For example, when building a new product feature the Product Manager is the DRI for the prioritization and the Engineering Manager is the DRI for delivery. As managers of one GitLab team members are most often the DRI for the tasks they accomplish.

At times, someone may be a DRI for an entire process or project. Because this comes with additional responsibility, there are some suggested characteristics to keep in mind when assigning the DRI.

Mike Brown in his November 2015 article, [Project Management · 8 Characteristics of a DRI](#), lists the following:

1. Detail-orientated without ever losing a strong strategic perspective.
1. Calm under the pressure of implementation and deadlines.
1. A strong listener with great skill at asking questions.
1. Able to vary the direction of project (or tactic or task) in smart ways to keep moving toward the objective.
1. Adept at anticipating potential problems and addressing them early.
1. Able to successfully interact at senior and junior levels within the organization.
1. Resilient in order to recover from setbacks.
1. Consistent in how they respond to comparable situations.

The DRI is also part of a team, a team needs to be motivated and aligned on achieving the steps to get to success.

The DRI will also be responsible for making sure the team gets there.

Communication and feedback

A DRI should be able to articulate the objectives, check progress and give and receive feedback.

This will ensure the DRI can change direction or plan ahead to avoid any setbacks.

At GitLab we communicate and work asynchronously, you can read more about it on [this page](#).

One thing to consider when a DRI needs to give or receive feedback is that they may not be the actual manager of the other members of the team.

Giving or receiving feedback is tough and we have looked at this in our previous [Guidance on Feedback Training](#). See also GitLab's [guide to communicating effectively and responsibly through text](#).

DRI, Consulted, Informed (DCI)

Different organizations use different methods of assigning responsibility; one of the most popular is the RACI Matrix, which outlines who the Responsible-Accountable-Consulted-Informed people should be on a decision or project.

GitLab's implementation of a DRI for decision-making means that we have evolved the RACI matrix to DCI (DRI, Consulted, Informed).

The Responsible and Accountable person is the DRI, the Consulted people are those whose opinions are sought, typically subject-matter experts; and with whom there is two-way communication. and Informed people are those who are kept up-to-date on progress, often only on completion of the task or deliverable; and with whom there is just one-way communication. Given that Everyone Can Contribute, Informed people also includes Everyone.

The DRI should be sure to Consult with all teams that have actions to take on an initiative to ensure they have all context and that actions are appropriately divided.

Circumstances Requiring the Rare Need for Approvals

There are circumstances where we do approvals for coordination or have a decision maker who is not the DRI. These are extremely rare. It is the responsibility of the DRI to recognize the need for this and to continue to move the project forward. Most of these circumstances will happen in instances in which initiatives:

- Involve 3-or-more functions
- Could have a large financial impact
- Could present significant risk to the business
- Have business reputation considerations
- Have multiple success considerations (for instance, increase iACV through a product change AND maintain customer NPS)

Examples include:

- A large cross-functional initiative that has significant reputational or financial implications for the GitLab and its users, such as a pricing initiative
- The rollout of a major policy change that requires multiple functions to align on a coordinated response (for example, legal, marketing, finance), such as changes to the Terms of Service

In these instances, another person may own the final decision, but this doesn't mean that key process steps should be skipped and other key stakeholders shouldn't be involved in ensuring a successful outcome. If a DRI is not considering key stakeholder feedback, executing without adequately planning for success, and saying, "the E-Group approved this," it is worth pausing and considering whether key steps are being missed or additional items should be considered. The DRI is still responsible for successful execution once a decision is made. If the DRI disagrees with a decision, it is this person's responsibility to make a compelling case to the decision maker in order to change the decision maker's mind. If this can't be done within a reasonable period of time, the DRI should disagree and commit.

Further reading

1. How well does Apple's DRI model work in practice
1. Matthew Mamet, DRI
1. Communicating effectively and responsibly through text
1. GitLab Handbook, Guidance on Feedback

SECTION: people-group/employment-solutions.md

This page contains an overview of how we have scaled team members Globally. The DRI for all Employment Solutions is the Employment Solutions Partner. Any changes to any contracts should be requested to the Employment Solutions Partner and will require approval from our Director of Tax & our Director of Legal, Employment.

Country Hiring Guidelines

The GitLab team has members in countries and regions all over the world and from all walks of life. Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging is one of our core values. Maintaining operations in a large number of countries, some of which have complex rules, laws, and regulations, can affect our ability to conduct business efficiently. Unfortunately, this affects the employability of the citizens and residents of those countries. We are continuously exploring our hiring capabilities in a variety of geographies.

All of our roles are remote, however, some roles may carry specific location-based eligibility requirements. Our Talent Acquisition team can help answer any questions applicants may have about location after starting the recruiting process.

In the past GitLab would hire in any country except those we had already determined were not feasible due to certain restrictions. At present, we are focussing our hiring in countries where we have an entity or a PEO, that do not carry any hiring restrictions. More details can be found in our internal compensation calculator under country hiring status.

Compared with our former approach of hiring contractors in any country and later planning to implement an entity/PEO, we see four instant benefits with this approach:

- Delivers consistent global team member experience (e.g. payroll, benefits, support, etc.)
- Reduces operational complexity
- Provides a stable footprint and makes it easier to grow in particular countries
- Closes the gap in building a scalable employment solution for 100% of team members

We can consider an exception to hire outside of these countries through the use of a PEO for future team members when supported by business needs, on a case-by-case basis. This approach enables a scalable solution from the onset and allows us to continue to hire diverse global talent whilst providing a consistent and positive team member experience. This approach will require a formal business need justification and will be addressed on a case-by-case basis.

Countries that do not have an entity/scalable PEO will be converted as part of our country conversion process.

Team Member Types at GitLab

Team Member Type Abbreviation Location
----- ----- -----
Employee Employee Global
Contractor : IND Cont-IND Non-US

Contractor : C2C	Cont-C2C	Non-US
Employee : PEO	Emp-PEO	Non-US
Contractor : PEO	Cont-PEO	Non-US
Intern	Intern	Global

- C2C means Company to Company
- IND means Independent
- For more information on Contingent Workers, please review the please review the Procurement handbook page.

Team Member Types by Country

GitLab has a few different team member types. The following tables each show how we hire and scale around the world, where we have entities, where we use Professional Employer Organisations, and how we add new countries to our list.

To ensure the accurate entry of information in Workday, we created this table as guidance of what is applicable in which location. When adding new team members to Workday, please ensure you use this terminology for accurate reporting.

More information related to payroll processes can be found on the Payroll handbook page.

GitLab Entities and Branches

Note: In countries with a star (*) hiring is limited to only certain roles, more detail can be found in our internal compensation calculator under Country Hiring Status, found in the top right menu.

Country		Team Member Type(s) Entity	
Pay Frequency Paid By		Workday Profile (Y/N)	
-----		-----	
-----		-----	
-----		-----	
Australia		Employee GitLab	
PTY Ltd		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Belgium		Employee GitLab BV	
13.92 GitLab Payroll Dept Y			
Canada		Employee GitLab	
Canada Corp		26 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Finland		Employee GitLab BV	
12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y			
France		Employee GitLab	
France S.A.S.		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Germany		Employee GitLab	
GmbH		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Ireland		Employee GitLab	

Ireland Ltd		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Israel		Employee	GitLab
Israel Ltd.		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Japan		Employee	GitLab GK
12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y			
Netherlands		Employee	GitLab BV
12.96 GitLab Payroll Dept Y			
New Zealand		Employee	GitLab PTY
Ltd NZ (Branch of GitLab PTY Ltd Australia)		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Singapore		Employee	GitLab
Singapore PTE. LTD		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
South Korea		Employee	GitLab
Korea Limited		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
Spain		Employee	GitLab
Iberia S.L.		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
United Kingdom (England, Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland)		Employee	GitLab UK
Ltd		12 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
United States		Employee	GitLab
Inc		24 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	
United States (Public Sector)		Employee	GitLab
Federal LLC		24 GitLab Payroll Dept Y	

PEO (Professional Employer Organization/ Employer of Record and not a GitLab entity or Branch)

This table reflects the countries in which we utilize PEO's. These countries are open for hiring but there may be times where we pause, close or are unable to hire in a given location due to the limitations or requirements of a particular role, or as a result of key projects or business needs. Our Talent Acquisition team can help answer any questions applicants may have about location once the recruiting process has begun:

Note: In countries with a star (*) hiring is limited to only certain roles, more detail can be found in our internal compensation calculator under Country Hiring Status.

Country	Agreement Type(s)	Hiring Partner	Entity to Invoice (for AP only)	Pay Frequency	Paid By	Currency paid in	Workday Profile (Y/N)	Scalable PEO (Y/N)	Open for hiring (Y/N)
Austria	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc						
14	PEO	EUR	Y	Y	Y				

	Chile	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc	
12	PEO	CLP	Y	Y	Y
	Costa Rica	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc	
12	PEO	USD	Y	Y	Y
	India	Employed via a PEO	Global Upside	GitLab IT BV	
12	PEO	INR	Y	Y	Y
	Kenya	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc	
12	PEO	KES	Y	Y	Y
	Latvia	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc	
12	PEO	EUR	Y	Y	Y
	Luxembourg	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com	GitLab IT BV	
12	PEO	EUR	Y	Y	Y
	Mexico	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab IT BV	
12	PEO	MXN	Y	Y	Y
	Philippines	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab IT BV	
24	PEO	PHP	Y	Y	Y
	South Africa	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion	GitLab Services Inc	
12	PEO	ZAR	Y	Y	Y
	Switzerland	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com	GitLab IT BV	
12	PEO	CHF	Y	Y	Y
	Sweden	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com	GitLab IT BV	
12	PEO	SEK	Y	Y	Y

This table reflects the countries in which we have utilized PEO's but are currently NOT open for hiring.

There are no current plans to open these countries for future hiring. If we do open for hiring, it will be based on business needs.

More detail can be found in our internal compensation calculator under Country Hiring Status.

Country	Agreement Type(s)	Hiring Partner	Entity to invoice (for AP only)
Pay Frequency	Paid By	Currency Paid in	Workday Profile (Y/N)
Employer of Record	Open for hiring (Y/N)		

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Armenia	Contracted via a PEO	CXC	GitLab IT BV
12	PEO	USD	Y
			N

12	Czech Republic	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	CZK	Y	N	N	
12	Greece	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR	Y	N	N	
12	Poland	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	PLN, EUR, USD	Y	N	N	
12	Portugal	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR	Y	N	N	
12	Romania	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR, USD	Y	N	N	
12	Serbia	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR	Y	N	N	
12	Slovenia	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR	Y	N	N	
12	Turkey	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	USD	Y	N	N	
12	Ukraine	Contracted via a PEO	CXC		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	USD, EUR	Y	N	N	
12	Hungary	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	HUF	Y	Y	N	
12	Denmark	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	DKK	Y	Y	N	
12	Brazil	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	BRL	Y	Y	N	
12	UAE	Employed via a PEO	Global Expansion		GitLab Services Inc	
	PEO	AED	Y	Y	N	
14	Italy	Employed via a PEO	Remote.com		GitLab IT BV	
	PEO	EUR	Y	Y	N	

Contact information for our PEO representatives is found in the Entity & PEO Contacts note in the PeopleOps vault in 1Password. If a team member, manager or PBP has a question relating to a PEO, their process, or any related procedure for a PEO-employed team member, please reach out to the Employment Solutions Partner (@hdevlin) who will liaise and find a solution with the PEO's support.

Team Members Hired as Contractors via our GitLab IT BV Entity

Where we do not have an entity or a PEO, team members contract with our GitLab IT BV entity as independent or C2C contractors. We are not currently hiring in locations that do not have an entity or PEO. Some PEO's are not open for hiring, see table above for details.

International Expansion

Country Conversions

As GitLab continues to scale, we will be converting all team members to an employment scalable solution. Team members are hired in the following ways:

- Contractor through a PEO (Professional Employer Organization with a local presence)
- Employees through a PEO (Professional Employer Organization)
- GitLab entity

The Employment Solutions Partner is responsible for managing the country conversion processes outlined here.

Compensation Review for Country Conversions

As part of the country conversion and benefits review process, the Total Rewards and Employment Solutions Partner will review the gross value of cash compensation and benefits while also ensuring alignment to the employee rate in the compensation calculator.

The Total Rewards and People Connect Team member should also review alignment to the compensation ranges based on the new employee status and the range of the compensation calculator. Whenever we change salaries as part of a country conversion, these should be consistently applied among all team members in that country.

WBSO (R&D tax credit) in the Netherlands

For roles directly relating to Research and Development in the Netherlands, GitLab may be eligible for the WBSO (R&D Tax Credit).

Organizing WBSO

Applications

As of 2019 GitLab must submit three applications each year and the deadlines for those are as follows:

1. 31 March 2019, for the May - August 2019 period (Product Manager for Create Features)
1. 31 August 2019, for the September - December 2019 period (Product Manager for Gitaly)
1. 30 November 2019, for the January - April 2020 period (Product Manager for Geo Features)

There is a translated English version of the application template located in the WBSO folder on the Google Drive. The applications should be completed by a Product Manager, responsible for features or a service within GitLab, who can detail the technical issues that a particular feature will solve. Assistance on completing the application can also be sought from the WBSO consultant (based in the Netherlands). The contact details for the consultant can be found in a

secure note in the People Ops 1Password vault called WBSO Consultant. The People Connect Team member will assist with co-ordinating this process. It is currently owned by Finance.

Hour Tracker

Each year a spreadsheet with the project details and hours logged against the work done on the project(s) will need to be created. This is for the entire year. The current hour tracker is located in the WBSO folder on the Google Drive, and shared only with the developers that need to log their hours (located in the Netherlands), Total Rewards Analysts, Finance and the WBSO consultant. Once the projects have been completed for the year, the WBSO consultant will submit the hours and project details to claim the R&D grant from the RVO. The WBSO consultant will contact Total Rewards Analysts should they have any queries.

Engineering internships

Engineering is currently hiring interns. The engineering internships handbook page has more information on this.

Internships require a fixed term contract during the internship, which is not possible in all countries.

The countries where we currently can hire interns are:

- Australia
- Austria
- Canada
- Chile
- Costa Rica
- Germany
- Ireland
- Japan
- Kenya
- Latvia
- Mexico
- Netherlands
- New Zealand
- Philippines
- Singapore
- South Africa
- South Korea
- United Kingdom
- United States

SECTION: people-group/engagement.md

Surveys Overview

As an all-remote company, there are several surveys we run to better understand the GitLab

culture, team member engagement, and overall health of the organization.

Seeking inputs from team members by surveying people is a key part of GitLab's engagement strategy and helps the People Group to align our priorities to the areas team members care about most.

There are different survey types that we run at different times throughout the year, each with different intended outcomes:

- Employer Award surveys: we ask team members to complete employer award surveys (i.e. Great Place to Work) to understand how GitLab compares against our talent competitors and to give future candidates insight into what it would look like to work here. The process for selecting and participating in employer award surveys is outlined in the Talent Brand section of the handbook.
- Engagement survey: We partner with CultureAmp to host and run our engagement surveys. We ask all team members to complete this survey at least once a year to understand how engagement is tracking over time.
- Organizational Health survey: we will sometimes run a survey to understand our company and culture more fully (i.e. McKinsey OHI survey) and classify these efforts as Organizational Health surveys.

Employer Award surveys

Great Place to Work

Great Place to Work recognizes companies for their outstanding workplace culture, benefits and performance through successful completion of a regional team member survey and culture brief application. They partner with Fortune to produce the Fortune 100 Best Companies list annually. The survey is based off of the following components:

1. US-based respondents only
1. Surveyed over a 2-week period
1. 61 Statements
1. 14 On-Survey Demographic Questions
1. 2 Open-Ended Questions

<details><summary>FY26 Great Place to Work Survey Results</summary>

GitLab received Great Place to Work Certification for the 5th year in a row in the US in April 2025 and was recognized as a top employer where team members are proud to work.

1. 87% average of all statements
1. 92% of team members say GitLab is a Great Place to Work

Read more about the survey results.

</details>

<details><summary>FY25 Great Place to Work Survey Results</summary>

GitLab received Great Place to Work Certification for the 4th year in a row in the US in May 2024 and was recognized as a top employer where team members are proud to work.

- 1. 87% average of all statements
- 1. 93% of team members say GitLab is a Great Place to Work

Read more about the survey results.

</details>

<details><summary>FY24 Great Place to Work Survey Results</summary>

GitLab received Great Place to Work Certification for the 3rd year in a row in the US in May 2023 and was recognized for our outstanding company culture.

- 1. 85% average of all statements
- 1. 89% of team members say GitLab is a Great Place to Work

Read more about the survey results.

</details>

<details><summary>FY23 Great Place to Work Survey Result</summary>

GitLab received Great Place to Work Certification for the 2nd year in a row in the US in December 2021 and was recognized for our outstanding company culture.

- 1. 93% average of all statements
- 1. 96% of team members say GitLab is a Great Place to Work

Read more about the survey results.

</details>

CultureAmp Engagement Survey Overview

Team Member Engagement is important to the continued success of GitLab making the Engagement Survey an important element within the annual People Group calendar. Engagement strategies have been shown to reduce attrition; improve productivity and efficiency; further embed the company values and ultimately enhance role satisfaction.

We partner with CultureAmp to run our Engagement Surveys. CultureAmp provides a platform to gather feedback confidentially, benchmark against external comparables, and uses algorithms to highlight which areas matter most to our team members.

Engagement surveys are geared toward giving team members an opportunity to provide feedback in terms of their experience within GitLab touching on pertinent elements such as Company Culture, Teamwork, Management and Inclusion among others.

Feedback from the survey in turn allows Leadership within GitLab to gain insight into what is

most important to team members, in particular what the business is doing well and what may need future iteration with the intention of improving the underlying team member experience and ensuring healthy levels of attrition are maintained.

Survey Confidentiality

In an effort to ensure team member confidentiality is upheld, only managers with >5 respondents will be able to view quantitative results - this is carried across to demographic filtering in teams with population sizes which exceed the minimum too. The survey is wholly administered by Culture Amp on a secure external website and the survey data will not be stored on any local computer. If you'd like to know more, check out CultureAmp's FAQ guide.

Survey Participation

To make sure we hear from as many team members as possible, the People Group will provide Divisional leaders and People Business Partners with access to participation rates at the Divisional level and to managers with 5 or more direct reports.

We will share with individual managers how close they are to receiving enough responses to view a detailed report noting that managers can only see individualized results for their teams if 5 or more of their direct reports complete the survey. We will not report participation statistics for managers with fewer than 5 direct reports.

Survey Sections and Factors

The GitLab Team Member Engagement Survey is comprised of eleven sections each of which is aligned to a specific area of focus otherwise known as a factor.

The survey factors we primarily focus on:

1. Overall Sentiment and Inclusivity
2. Confidence in GitLab and Management
3. Your Role & Connecting at GitLab
4. Team and Company Values
5. Action
6. Open text questions

Overall survey ranges anywhere from 40 to 50 questions. The format of the survey was predominantly Likert or Rating Scale with a handful of free text questions or comments toward the end. The favorable score is the percentage of participants who selected 'agree' and 'strongly agree'.

FY'26 Engagement Survey

Our Engagement Survey for FY'26 is scheduled to run from 2025-06-16 to 2025-06-27. The survey will be open to all team members with start dates before 2025-05-31.

FY'26 Annual Engagement Survey Timeline

- 2025-06-16: Survey launch @ 8am PT/3pm UTC

- 2025-06-27: Survey close @ 5pm PT/2025-06-28 12am UTC
- 2025-07-01: High-level summary shared with People Leadership Team
- 2025-07-03: High-level summary & Culture Amp reports shared with E-Group
- Week of 7th July: Functional Leaders level reports shared in CultureAmp
- Week of 7th July: All People Managers level reports shared in CultreAmp
- Week of 14th July : High-level summary release (company-wide) and followed by handbook updates
- Week of 14th July: Division-level results summary shared by division leaders
- Week of 1st August - Finalize company wide action plans

Only leaders with 5 or more respondents will receive a report in CultreAmp

FY'25 Engagement Survey

Our Engagement Survey for FY'25 is scheduled to run from 2024-06-17 to 2024-06-28. Survey will be open to all team members hired before 2024-05-31.

FY'25 Annual Engagement Survey Timeline

- 2024-06-17: Survey launch @ 8am PT
- 2024-06-28: Survey close @ 5pm PT
- 2024-07-08: High-level summary shared with People Leadership Team
- 2024-07-10: High-level summary shared with E-Group
- 2024-07-15: Vice President, Sr. Director, and Director level reports shared in CultureAmp
- 2024-07-16: Sr. Manager and Manager level reports shared in CultreAmp
- 2024-08-19: High-level summary release (company-wide) and followed by handbook updates
- 2024-07-18 through 2024-08-30: Division-level results summary shared by division leaders
- Q3 - Finalize Division specific action plans

Only leaders with 5 or more respondents will receive a report in CultreAmp

FY'25 Engagement Survey Results

Our FY'25 Annual Engagement Survey ran from 2024-06-17 to 2024-06-28. The survey was open to team members hired before 2024-05-31.

- We reached 83% participation which is 8% higher than the Post-Summit Survey and 5% lower than the FY24 Engagement survey.
- Overall engagement score of 78% favourable, 14% neutral and 8% unfavourable.
- We scored 3% higher than we did in the FY'24 Engagement Survey overall, and 7% higher than our New Tech peer group, which consists of ~200 fast growing and disruptive tech companies who have ~1000+ total team members.
- GitLab remains in a strong position from an overall engagement score perspective with several opportunities highlighted in the detailed results section.

Below you will find a summary of our overall results, as well as key insights and opportunities. A huge thanks to everyone who completed the survey and made their voices heard. Your feedback helps us to continually improve the experience of working at GitLab.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable	Neutral	Unfavourable
78%	14%	8%

Detailed Results (Overall)

We've documented our detailed FY25 Annual Engagement Survey results in a presentation that is available only for GitLab team members.

Those detailed results highlight the strengths and opportunities shared below in greater detail.

Top Three Scores

In addition to Engagement, we asked questions about other factors regarding our workplace and culture. A factor score is the average score of all questions within that factor.

Factor	Favourability Rating
Psychological Safety	90%
Your Manager	83%
Values	82%

Top Scores - Individual statements	Favourability Rating
I enjoy engaging with my peers at GitLab	94%
It is easy to ask other members of your team for help	92%
No one on my team would deliberately act in a way that undermines my efforts	91%

Top Three Opportunities

Factor	Favourability Rating
Action	60%
Benefits & Compensation	63%
Company Confidence	64%

Opportunities - Individual statements	Favourability Rating
I believe action will take place as a result of this survey	58%
GitLab effectively directs resources (funding, people and effort) towards company goals	59%
Most of the systems and processes here support us getting our work done effectively	59%

Using Epics and Issues to Create an Action Plan

All divisions are recommended to create an Epic to store Engagement Survey Action Issues. Every Division should create an Epic that gives an overview of the engagement survey results that includes: highlights, lowlights, recommended actions, and resources. Epics can be created in division issue boards or projects that are applicable to the organization.

In addition, Managers can create an Engagement Survey Action Issue that links to the division wide Epic. In the Issue, managers can link team wide actions to the division. Here is the recommended action planning tips for managers.

FY25 Engagement Survey Action Planning Epics

- Company wide focus areas
- Product
- Engineering
- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- People
- LACA
- CISO

<details>

<summary markdown="span">FY'23 and prior Years Engagement Surveys</summary>

Summit Pulse Surveys Overview

The goal of the Summit is to build trust through social connections. This trust should lead to higher individual and team motivation, leading to higher productivity and retention. Higher trust between individuals and teams fuels collaboration and leads to stronger results.

To best determine how effective we are at achieving the goal of Summit is to gauge team member perceptions before and after the event.

We ran two surveys

- Pre-Summit: January 9, 2024 to January 19, 2024
- Post-Summit: March 15, 2024 to April 5, 2024

This will helped us gain valuable insights into any shifts in sentiments among team members, allowing us to assess the true impact of the summit, satisfaction and engagement.

This is an abbreviated version of our engagement survey, and it also includes a few Summit related questions.

Survey Results

Team members can access Summit Pulse Survey results here

FY'24 Engagement Survey

FY'24 Engagement Survey Timeline

- 2023-05-16: Engagement Survey launch
- 2023-06-07: Engagement Survey close
- 2023-06-16: Results shared with e-group
- 2023-06-21: Results shared with VPs

- 2023-06-22: Managers with 5+ responses receive reports via Culture Amp
- 2023-06-22: Initial results at the Q2 Assembly
- 2023-06-22 through 2023-07-04: Leaders/Managers review their reports and discuss/brainstorm action plans in Staff/team meetings
- 2023-07-21: Target date for full results shared company-wide
- 2023-07-30: Finalize Action items and document in epics/issues
- 2023-08-01: Division action plans added to FY'24 Q3 OKRs and Division epics
- 2023-08-31: Department action plans (if applicable) complete

FY'24 Q2 Engagement Survey Results

Our Engagement Survey FY'24 Q2 ran from 2023-05-22 to 2023-06-07. The survey was opened to team members hired before 2023-04-30.

- We reached 88% participation which is 6% higher than the FY23 Pulse Engagement survey.
- Overall engagement score of 75% favorable, 17% neutral and 8% unfavourable.
- We scored 6% lower than we did in the FY'23 Q2 Engagement Survey overall, but this score is still 2% higher than our New Tech peer group, which consists of ~200 fast growing and disruptive tech companies who have ~1000+ total team members.
- Amongst our SaaS Talent Peers of 1000+ team members, Culture Amp shared that engagement scores are decreasing by 5-10% due to macroeconomic conditions and uncertainty in the industry.
- GitLab remains in a strong position from an overall engagement score perspective with several opportunities highlighted in the detailed results section.

Below you will find a summary of our overall results, as well as key insights and opportunities. A huge thanks to everyone who completed the survey and made their voices heard. Your feedback helps us to continually improve the experience of working at GitLab.

Company Results (Overall)

Favourable	Neutral	Unfavourable
-----	-----	-----
75%	17%	8%

Detailed Results (Overall)

We've documented our detailed FY24 Culture Amp Engagement survey results in a presentation that is available only for GitLab team members.

Those detailed results highlight the strengths and opportunities shared below in greater detail.

Top Three Scores

In addition to Engagement, we asked questions about other factors regarding our workplace and culture. A factor score is the average score of all questions within that factor.

Factor	Favourability Rating
-----	-----
Psychological Safety	88%

| Your Manager | 84% |
| Connectedness | 78% |

Top Scores - Individual statements	Favourability Rating
I enjoy engaging with my peers at GitLab	94%
It is easy to ask other members of your team for help	92%
No one on my team would deliberately act in a way that undermines my efforts	91%

Top Three Opportunities

Factor	Favourability Rating
Action	58%
Company Confidence	60%
Our Leaders	62%

Opportunities - Individual statements	Favourability Rating
I believe action will take place as a result of this survey	55%
GitLab effectively directs resources (funding, people and effort) towards company goals	57%
When there are career opportunities at GitLab, I am aware of them	58%

Additional analysis associated with these opportunities is included in our detailed FY24 Culture Amp Engagement survey results presentation that is available only for GitLab team members.

Using Epics and Issues to Create an Action Plan

For the FY24 Engagement Survey, all divisions are recommended to create an Epic to store Engagement Survey Action Issues. Every Division should create an Epic that gives an overview of the engagement survey results that includes: highlights, lowlights, recommended actions, and resources. Epic's can be created in division issue boards or projects that are applicable to the organization.

In addition, Managers can create an Engagem